

r/vegan

anyone else been seeing so many posts about stopping AI usage because of water waste?

Posted by u/blahblablah1244 • 0 points • 41 comments

While of course I encourage any type of movement towards being more environmentally friendly, I can't help but wish I was seeing this same energy for the meat industry.

I mean I have had seen so many posts from people in my circles from people about how "if you continue to use AI you are killing the planet", yet I know all of them personally and they all eat meat.

And its not just people I know in real life, I'm seeing so many mega viral posts on tiktok and instagram about this, like MILLIONS of tiktok likes, I wish we had even half the amount of care for the meat industry.

I mean seriously the amount of water AI uses is miniscule to the amount of water and land and resources used for animal agriculture. Or even just the amount of water used for one pound of beef.

It makes me frustrated because I wish we got this same type of support, talking about the impacts of eating animals online is always met with some type of vitrol or disregard. Just wish things could be different.

Comments

u/SanctimoniousVegoon • 1 points • 2025-01-11 20:36 UTC

Yep, sure have. It got me worked up enough that I felt the need to say something (also happens that I live in LA). Posted an entire series of stories that was basically a direct subtweet to all those people in my circle posting about AI. Went deep into the facts about animal ag's environmental toll and actually said "if you haven't at minimum **started** the process of ending your animal product consumption, I can't take anything you have to say about climate change seriously." Also said "I am unapologetic in my stance that >99% of you reading this have no morally justifiable reason to not be vegan."

And you know what? It went over incredibly well. I got NO pushback, several DMs thanking me for the info, and one DM from someone asking for help to go vegan.

I regret not unapologetically speaking up on my socials sooner.

u/Cute_Mouse6436 • 1 points • 2025-01-11 17:09 UTC

Perhaps we vegans can post about how consuming animal products is contributing to climate change/global warming / deforestation /famine /water table dropping... as well as animal suffering, but not in the same posts?

What would be some catchy "bumper sticker" phrases?

What is a succinct way of saying choose plant products?

"Plant products preserve prosperity!" hum...😊 Do you like this?

u/extropiantranshuman • 2 points • 2025-01-11 16:25 UTC

we all collectively feel this way. Honestly - AI will save the planet by telling people to stop consuming animal products - and since they don't want that word out, since it'll make them admit their wrongdoing to where whatever eco cost of ai is surpassed by its benefits - that for them, it just can't be, because then the world would actually go in the right direction and we'd have vegantopia on earth - which would be the end of the world for them. So yeah - they just want to hide ai from liberating people to do better by fearmongering. Classic carnistic tactic.

u/MeisterDejv • 0 points • 2025-01-11 18:47 UTC

Except AI has a lot of issues beyond just water usage. Most of silicon is used to make hardware (graphics cards) for it just so it can be used for mostly useless (sometimes even dangerous) mass generation of low quality content and factually wrong information, where this silicon could have better application otherwise. All these AI companies think solely about profit without much thought about long term goals, they aggressively have to hype the product even though AI has already entered diminishing returns of development.

I'm not even using neo-Luddite arguments here, AI is overhyped technology with more limited usage and bad efficiency when used for generative purposes. Content it creates is just vomit-inducing. I'm not exactly sure how it will put light on animal agriculture and animal rights issues. If anything, some people think AI is sentient but that non-human animals (except for dogs I guess) are not.

u/extropiantranshuman • 1 points • 2025-01-11 19:27 UTC

Sure - overhyping is a waste - but the issue is with overhyping as much as underhyping it.

I always thought it wasn't really the field to go into myself - so I didn't and thought it was strange that others were trying to put their brain power into building an artificial version of their own when they could build their own, so of course that kind of mentality is vomit-inducing in of itself. It's like cybersecurity - you have to think what's the point of going through all of the steps of it for what purpose when there's better to work on.

It's that vegans can build ai chatbots to let non-vegans ask questions to instead of them. It's important to not isolate ai as being bad when maybe relevantly it is less water wasting. Realize for humans to go out of their way to explain everything when they can just put it into a robot to do it for them is a lot more water efficient, as humans consume water too - along with food for brain power.

That's the issue with these naysayers - they stop people from thinking about the opportunity that negates any of their concerns - that they'd rather yell 'no' than think with their own minds - if they really cared about HI (human intelligence) so much.

They really do work against themselves for all the effort they put forth honestly to advocate for something that just doesn't help their own cause of uplifting human brain power, but who am I to judge here really.

u/Sea-Status-6999 • 2 points • 2025-01-11 13:28 UTC

i think people feel able to 'care' about the use of AI because it's still new and being implemented so the aim is to sort of stop it in its tracks. 'why are we introducing something that is only doing harm' type of thing. it's harder to do the same with the neat industry because it requires a reversal of behaviours